

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Saldron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 17, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-17_draft (P **HELD FLAT** at 1/1/18/38/70. There IS a new dated fact this cycle and it is supply-s outage is a "brief and temporary interruption" that "will be measured in days," and Saudi Arabia is targeting roughly half the damaged capacity back within days and full operations in about six weeks. Br That relieves an oil-supply squeeze — it does not change the war read, and analysts citing satellite imagery of the damaged pumping station warn repairs could run weeks. No flip line fires: the upside cl Iran still refuses to reopen the strait absent U.S. concessions, is talking to Oman rather than Washington directly, and the Salalah ministerial is still postponed with no new date. Brent above \$100 keeps th levels are MARKET PRICES, reported and not used to move P.) · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Prior committed set: Sept 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered vs. the morning draft) was left as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp) and **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026**. An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft held P flat but was never rendered/self-reviewed, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75, AUTO-STAMPED, the last COMMITTED set. **This section (score set 2026-09-02, draft) covers Sept 1-2:** the conflict escalated materially — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 oil tankers; a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Hormozgan (single-narrative-sourced, not scored directly); Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — all re-rated under 8 points per window. Originally left as draft Sept 2 pending Alex's manual review (single-narrative core fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp on their own — this is the last TRUE committed set. **Sept 3** — Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Kuwait/UAE, both repeat targets; P HELD FLAT. **Sept 5 (2026-09-05, draft)** advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself edited. **Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05, draft2, this version)** independently re-verifies via WebSearch, including the Sept 5 STARK 1/Kharg Island tanker report (still unconfirmed review and is **COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026**. **Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06, draft)** re-rates P down modestly to 1/8/25/45/73 once CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike; master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new committed baseline. **Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08, draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/7/20/40/70; Hormuz into the Persian Gulf — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but a threat of intent, not yet executed — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **2026-09-09, draft, this version)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/72: CENTCOM's own press release confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, and independent outlets — and Brent crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24, a single-day cross short of this pillar's sustained-\$100 flip line. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10, draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/5/22/42/72: the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base in retaliation for the Sept 8 tanker strike (18 intercepted, no casualties); chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced; Brent traded above \$100 for a second straight session, still short of a sustained close. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **2026-09-11, draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause fires on a third consecutive session (Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10, highest since May 1, 2026 member). No window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12, draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/3/19/39/69: Sept 11 (capturing Dhubab and Murad, the last government-held coastal towns) and seized Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a second global chokepoint moving from "oil" to "gas" vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire). No new flip-line clause fires (Yemen is existing theater; no US casualty), but this is a bigger step than the routine daily grind — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 13 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-13, draft)** researched the week via four parallel adversarial passes against the 2026-09-12 draft committed baseline and found one sufficiency-clearing new fact: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) was hit by drones launched from Iran "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark, not as fact); neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires. **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70). **LIGHT DAILY CATCH-UP (score set 2026-09-14, draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/0/16/36/66: **regardless of move size — awaiting Alex's manual review**. See My Decision below.

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	1
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	3

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four par committed baseline and surfaced ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond that morning baseline (which already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and the Sept kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11), a NEW target dist Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's req CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra. Iraq's PM ordered a probe of th border crossing as a precaution — corroborating, semi-primary. **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, speaking in Dublin, said Iran was NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire — Iran escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military casualty found this cycle. The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to trigger. **Also logged, not scored:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthi privately signaled to the administration they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — sin refused-strikes restraint counterweight; the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) voicing "deep concern over the continued escal civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independ Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the already-logged Warning 133-26. **Sizing:** a third distinct attack on Saudi oil infrastructure this week, speci Saudi MFA statement plus 6 independent outlets) for a modest further move given the persistent-pattern read — but it is a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty, so long-run strategic outlook, and the BRICS restraint statement is a modest offsetting data point at this horizon); 1mo held at the near-floor 1 — no further room reasoned. **This is a FULL WEEKLY move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW** — a second, distinct fire intraday cross and the Sept 10 second session came close to but did not cleanly fire, now fires on a third consecutive session: Brent **ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107** (closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; Thursday's actual close was far higher, above \$107. **BEARISH and NEW, second fact:** for ships and 8 oil tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign P confirmed-US-combat-death clause still does NOT fire; no strike on a further new state was confirmed, so the widening clause does not fire either. **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-)** average of 10-13 commodity vessels/day. **Counterweight, also logged:** Friday's give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around Hormuz plus the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction **the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71**. A clause of this pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation of its evidence standard — but under the runbook's wide sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar and verification passed clean, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72 (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM-confirmed ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base** — Jordan's armed forces say 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Sept 31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM and Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty clause also does NOT fire (DCAS remains 18 confirmed and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha** — a chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sub-further new state, and no trait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a further new state, now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line and worth close watching next cycle, but it does not independently fire that clause. Net: a re-intensifying the trend already priced without crossing any flip-line threshold. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 6-5, 6mo 23-22, 12mo 43-42, 36mo 73-72** (multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight call band did not flip), **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM-confirmed Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Khoran)** — **the preceding two days.** Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar, no further harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and this is a repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island are both existing theater), not a widening to a further new state — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — but this is a single-day intraday cross, not a confirmed-US-casualty clause either; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line. Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement (already logged in the Sept 8 baseline as a not-yet-executed theater, unspecified/forthcoming, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation/intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event, since **near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 7-6, 6mo 24-23, 12mo 44-43, 36mo 73-72.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNSC (Tehran Times) that Iran will declare, "in the coming days," a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering the zone would be signed "in the coming days."** This is corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) reporting the theater, not explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone had actually been confirmed-but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment), this is sized as a small continuation-of-escalation cut, not a flip-line event — Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 vessels redirected / 3 disabled / 2 destroyed — enforcement trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed (still "in the coming days" per Rezaei; the existing temporary 7-mile corridor from late August). **further room), 3mo 8-7, 6mo 25-24, 12mo 45-44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't move the multi-year thesis). This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM-confirmed, and is more serious than known.** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at US Navy vessels, evaded multiple attacks, no American personnel were harmed. Admiral Brad Cooper, CENTCOM's commander: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost on it (it had only Iran's Tasnim state-media claim, with AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially larger attack on US Navy vessels. Separately, Sept 6 (today) IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera Sept 6) — rule they are NOT independently used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: no confirmed new US combat death (DCAS still 18 as of Sept 4, unchanged), no confirmed new US Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. The cut is sized as a confirmed-US-casualty small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly cycle committed 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the loaded pillar's own Sept 1 note flagged.** CENTCOM confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran Sept 1-2 — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, communications sites, and Kharg Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump Sept 1 attacks. Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95-96.6/bbl, WTI to ~\$91-92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait of Hormuz) killed 5 dead, including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI). **Flagged EXPLICITLY AS SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level:** the casualty claim originally sourced to US has neither confirmed nor denied it — so per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does not move P, even though multiple Western outlets report the claim (wide pickup of a single-narrative triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously — Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait — a materially larger REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points since Feb-Jul 2026 per this war's own tracker pages), so the pillar's own Most projectiles were intercepted (Jordan: roughly 10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed with no reported casualties; Bahrain: most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted), and no confirmed new US Gulf of Oman clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is simply continuing and escalating in scale, which is why P moves further down. Iran threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military source told press Tehran's response would be "many times greater" (CNBC) — read as a confirmed-US-casualty point/window auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 7-1, 3mo 15-9, 6mo 32-27, 12mo 50-47, 36mo 75-74. **Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty claim narrative-sourced even though widely reported, so confidence in today's sizing was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event; (2) the scale jump (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct US strike on a REPEAT target); (3) both sides' on-record threats of much larger responses ahead raised the cost of a miscalibrated cut. It also independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band, disqualifying auto-stamp on its own. **On September 3, 2026, Alex reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and move size are no longer required.** The cut is unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not used to move P — only the stamping threshold changed. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below.

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM-confirmed day.** The Aug 30-31 cut (see below) was explicitly sized on the assumption that "one resumed-strike night is not yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened: US struck by three unknown projectiles ~17 nautical miles northeast of Khasab, Oman, during outbound transit — hit on the port side, engine room, and ballast tank; no casualties, no environment damage, no territorial waters, approaching from Iran — a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target claim (Aug 28), not a "further new" state per this pillar's own framing. President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Bloomberg, Reuters, USA Today, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire). The session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle of gains on this pillar's own thesis — continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports) on fresh-clash fears — so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor a clean "further new state struck" clause fires cleanly. This is a confirmed-US-casualty point/window auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 9-7, 3mo 17-15, 6mo 34-32, 12mo 51-50, 36mo 75-75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Bloomberg, Reuters, USA Today, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, and UKMTO. Prior to this, on Aug 30 US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island in the Strait of Hormuz after observing preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). This is a confirmed-US-casualty consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" committed trigger firing exactly as written. IRGC confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given) and retaliated hours later, into Aug 31, with ballistic missiles — 8 missiles, and Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure — unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception, so logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That cut was from a comparable single-incident shock: 1mo 14-9, 3mo 22-17, 6mo 38-34, 12mo 54-51 and 36mo 76-75. Prior to that, the Aug 29 full weekly refresh had held P flat at 14/22/38/54/76 or 14/22/38/54/76 on the **sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and confirmed by 5+ state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated as sanctioned under EO 13902. Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and Solana were "identified and landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant — a genuine escalation. It continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. The Aug 27 (engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM committed to Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade resumed — has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary-source)

68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed** (government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Termineering the mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait of Hormuz deal terms were disclosed in the joint statement; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded as "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz tanker strike, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~10%) of the whole crisis. Brent eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving toward "unwinding" on the Hormuz progress. No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, 2020). New US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation is not met** — US-accepted Hormuz deal holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains in limbo. Single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petroline pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus OilPrice.com), well above the sufficiency bar; the single-source Trump "probably Iran" attribution is explicitly NOT used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure (CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald), and the Khasab vessel strikes remain confirmed via UKMTO's own official warning plus 3+ independent outlets. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,440.74 on Sept 17, versus \$76,138.60 on Sept 16 and \$75,577.29 on Sept 15 (local time). The move is negative; per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 12, 2026 (full weekly refresh, re-checked Sept 12, P re-rated down further, modestly, as a third Saudi oil-infrastructure strike lands with sponsorship undetermined)

This cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it as further than the facts support. **Me:** the honest read sits between those: a drone strike launched from Iraqi soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a theater, not what earns a further small cut. I am explicit that Trump's Dublin remark is a single hedged guess, not evidence, and score accordingly; the move is small (3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each) precisely because it's a theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) and no US casualty — not because I am siding with either the "Iran did it" or "no proof, ignore it" framings. The BRICS restraint declaration and Trump's own announcement of a system that only reports escalation isn't honest either.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background theater. A routine tanker strike is structural, not emotional — Iran-aligned forces now hold actual chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that undercuts the existing theater, no US casualty). I am sizing this cut larger than the recent 1-point daily touches for exactly that reason, while still stopping short of treating it as a flip-line event, because it isn't directly reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move. The MBS-request-refused detail is logged honestly because it cuts the other way: the

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave the price down. A specific, falsifiable clause — a *sustained* Brent close above \$100 — and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles. What it does *not* do is change what the war is: still no confirmed US combat death since Sept 4, still no strike on a further new state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave was a merchant ship. A give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to the main theater. A linked airbase sounds large in isolation, but Jordan has now absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either. I am sizing this precisely because it's easy to dismiss: it's the same actor this pillar has tracked in the Red Sea/Bab al-Mandeb theater for months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in on" a new theater. A blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than either strike — not yet a sustained close, but the clearest signal yet. (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" — a real data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires. The section below rather than being quietly dropped. The CENTCOM-confirmed 5-tanker strike is a larger single incident than the 3-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same repeat pattern (an attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly again (1/6/23/43/72, from 1/7/24/44/73) rather than up.

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new theater. A strike across an expanded zone is a real escalatory signal worth logging and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incidents. I am sizing this (1/8/25/45/73) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fire on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100) and it is consistent with — not a departure from — this pillar's treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's the same "very close" pattern this pillar has tracked.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that Iran had fired but an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than up (Brent short of \$100) and the escalation — while more serious than previously known — was still a continuation of the same "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced in since Aug 30, not a new event. Explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops a claim like that from doing more work than it's earned.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as theater. The scale of the underlying US strike wave (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real event.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, but I am flagging it prominently for Alex's manual review. Three reasons, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is confirmed (confirming nor denying), even though it's widely reported; my confidence in today's sizing is lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve a cut this large. (2) the strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover, and sizing a cut for a genuinely new magnitude of event. (3) the sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the cut is still evidence-bounded, not price-driven. I fire the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause because all four targets are repeats.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation) but not letting confirmed facts (strike count, tanker strikes, four-country retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to stay honest.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp move. The move is negative; per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the

The Facts

As of September 12, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12, draft12) vs the 2026-09-12, draft committed baseline (this morning's light daily catch-up); this cycle's final score is yet to be determined.

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed)** — Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now. (The claim is supported by 6+ independent, satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing.
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. President Trump's remark, NOT treated as established fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US casualty).

- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, confirmed by New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) called for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure.
- ★ **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZDNet, etc.) — Warning 133-26.

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12, draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize Mocha** — second global oil chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing on a knife-edge.
- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of US strikes.
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf News, Reuters, etc.) — confirmed by US Navy.
- ★ **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation.
- ★ **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" flip-line clause.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** — was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500, etc.) — decisively so. *Correction:* the prior cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged ~\$101.25 as "Thursday Sept 10" — that was an intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks in decades** (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- ★ **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels per day — P under the house sufficiency rule.
- ★ **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand — does not either.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker raid** (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a SECOND global shipping chokepoint (South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on control of the Strait of Hormuz".
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9) — has come to this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- ★ **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS remains silent and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- ★ **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Darya** — over the preceding two days. Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroyed Five Iranian Oil Tankers").
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as US strikes oil tankers") — sustained close, so it does not independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it.
- ★ **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- ★ **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- ★ **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iran's own announcement.
- ★ **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an Iranian warship was shot down in research pass.
- ★ **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously** (one disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile cruiser). Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own release.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and the capture of two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- ★ **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and missile launchers. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — confirmed by multiple sources reporting strikes on Iranian state vessels.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuhestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's office (via Yahoo, UPI report the claim). CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities and is not the underlying fact. Per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does NOT move P; it is reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** 30-31 — but all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to a FURTHER" widening clause independently fires.
- ★ **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US escalation risk, not de-escalation.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles, engine room, and ballast tank. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incident.** The UAE MoD explicitly denied Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran. So: a Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicit.
- ★ **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- ★ **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31**, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — not a new.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launcher bases on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak. **Directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = true")
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two bases, intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed.
- ★ **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures**, reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Financial System") and actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. Includes Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations. **For the first time, digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and Solana, all primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, Oman co-hosts the joint statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent deal. Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of a "new" corridor was excluded.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO).
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian waters, commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade.
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest since 2015.
- ★ **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attacks.
- ★ **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-confirmed, westbound 29→42). Still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- ★ **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss > 5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the peak.
- ★ **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the stats).
- ★ **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- ★ **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and the Aug 28 briefing, also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including the 2025 Red Sea crisis) with the 2026 Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative deaths, 17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count above (19-20).
- ★ **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- ★ **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described it as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variation, not a genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on their own claims.
- ★ **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- ★ **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a completed deal (not a comprehensive, US-accepted deal).
- ★ **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21**, a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier *Al-Salam* was struck while exiting the Strait's southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News).

(draft2): the cumulative toll is a 15-19 range, not a clean figure — see the NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly stamped.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iran — a shift from attacks-only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE Fujairah port May 4, both predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to designation of 10 Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass.
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry down June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict.
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle" potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line (above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Iraq").
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure —
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, BBC; dispute read).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government; a lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent) reported; firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) reported a "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer viable."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident count is "at a trickle."
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that deepens the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA, these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News, independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).

- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CN weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework wa
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — b US casualties. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White Hou
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Was Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors"
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israe — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on t corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding or
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Ju
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, no
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't cr to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the "buy-the-invasion" rebound. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~\$34,300 intraday low, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+25-2 recovered within a week.

The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian been building since Aug 25 (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still technically on the table, unretracted, but a fresh, much-larger strike now. BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from Sept 1's \$78,038.78 — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own evidence. That's logged as a scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a corridor" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium unwinds for real." That's now considerably further away than it was even yesterday, not closer — the Prize doesn't feed the math, it te

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude windows (1mo, now at P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut when the underlying event is this much larger.

- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, but this cut without leaning on the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a pre-committed warning line. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign resumed but it's equally possible this is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side a structural fact, and a reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a pillar has never faced before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could resume clause alone.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange triggered cuts of similar or larger size.
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by S. "restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian and nuclear infrastructure, and Trump's own account describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. The pillar logs every new strike within a day while diplomatic restraint signals like these get folded in as a line, not a re-rate — a stricter reader could argue that asymmetry itself biases the cut direction.

The Triggers

ated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downside flip line FIRED August 30** (see the flip-line box below) — a resumption of direct continued sharply Sept 1–2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRCG missile attack on 2 US Navy warships; Iran's S-300s CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IRCG retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize the Yemeni coast Sept 9 — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, on a third consecutive session above \$100 including a close above \$107 on Sept 10. **By Sept 11-12, Houthi forces completed their sweep of Yemen's Red Sea coastline and seized Aden** — a control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in six weeks landed: Iran's foreign ministry announced Fri Sept 11 that the Strait of Hormuz navigation, safe shipping routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ independent outlets). It drives this pillar's** official's statement that no deal is expected, the fact that the agenda concerns managing a strait Iran still controls, and continued fighting on Sept 13 (a fatal vessel attack near Qeshm Island, a Houthi projectile on a **accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refresh, a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike landed** — drones launched from Iraqi territory hit Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline, a hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires.

DATE	EVENT
Logged Sept 15–17 — supply-side relief, NOT a war-risk flip; does not fire any clause	U.S. Energy Secretary Chris Wright (CNBC, Sept 15): the Saudi East–West pipeline outage is a “brief and temporary interruption” that “will be measured in days.” Saudi Arabia is targeting roughly half the damaged capacity back within days and full operations in about six weeks, and is offering extra crude to Asian routes near Oman. Brent settled \$105.83 (–2.7%) Sept 16 and traded near \$102.85 Sept 17; WTI settled \$102.43 (–3.2%). Counterweight: independent analysts' satellite imagery of the damaged pumping station warn repairs could run weeks.
FIRE d Sept 13 — PRIMARY (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)	The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date. ONA: the meeting is “postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue.” Bahrain had explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to a ministerial level. Iran's MFA says Saudi Arabia requested the delay citing Yemen and calls that a pretext — <i>single-party-sourced to Iranian officials, reported not scored</i> . Separately, Araqchi said the Iran-Oman understanding “would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz” (Tehran Times/Mehr). Brent +2.8% past \$107, WTI \$102.34 –0.3%, <i>prices, reported not scored</i> .
Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11–12 — PRIMARY (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above	First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February. The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convene in Salalah, Oman to discuss Strait of Hormuz navigation — safe/temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of U.S.-mediated Iran-Oman talks. Iranian MFA: the gathering aims “to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security” (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS). Logged counterweight: announced Sept 12 it will not attend; an Iranian official told JPost no signed deal is expected; Tehran is weighing a transit service-fee regime, i.e. the agenda is about managing a strait Iran still controls
Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran's attribution is Iran's own and is NOT treated as established	A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the “US terrorist entity” Houthi projectile struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government confirm the trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb
Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P	Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage attributes it to the lack of diplomacy plus the IEA's demand-contraction forecast (TradingEconomics, Forbes)
Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)	Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory; Saudi MFA says it is not a war-risk flip; does not fire any clause; pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina struck, injuries and material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com). Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, closed the Shalamcheh border crossing. (Dublin): Iran “probably” responsible — single, hedged, unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact
Fired Sept 10–11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait; fighting continues for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct action was refused (intel/targeting support offered instead)
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133–26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborate). Logged, not used to move P (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation
FIRE d Sept 10–11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	“Sustained Brent close above \$100” — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 1998, above \$102 for the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Three consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read close
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10–11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; at least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces say 1 was intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10–11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as Thursday's level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (CNBC, ABC News; crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries,” ABC News)
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days (“US Destroys Five Iranian Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship,” centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)
Announced Sept 6–7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new “restricted zone” beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf “in the coming days,” with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed “in the coming days” (Press TV, Tehran Times, Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)

Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask), M/T (destroyed, Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both evaded; no US personnel harmed (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Jazeera live blog, Euronews)
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; a night of launches followed
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; the governor has neither confirmed nor denied it
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (engine room, ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone over its territorial waters
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines in the Strait — first US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Scott Miller
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims 100% damage, "unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vendors designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through the Strait of Hormuz waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee term; Oman itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, off Iran, no damage onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, RedState, IranWire)
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still well below the pre-war baseline
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Reuters, Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing tally of 1
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed

Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eased as traffic stays low
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks" as traffic stays low
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new attack
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired** — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first confirmed new **\$100" clause has fired too** — three consecutive sessions above \$100, including a close above \$107 on Sept 10, its highest since May 19. Two of the four clauses are now live; the remaining two (a confirmed new **strikes clause was already firing again at vastly greater scale** — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets struck (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers — but none of the confirmed new **strikes clause** is unfired (no confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — confirmed attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6 but remains short of a sustained \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line. The Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld — a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single-source IRGC claims of additional strikes. Neither is a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority (sourcing is primary/multi-cycle). **that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure.** Oman's own government confirmed a temporary corridor Aug 25, but the confirmed direct US–Iran naval exchange makes a durable corridor claims are independently confirmed, whether either side's threatened "much larger"/"significantly larger" response actually materializes, a confirmed US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, likely warrant a larger cut. **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters the zone (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 9:** CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IR casualty, so neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 (~\$100.44) — the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday cross is not a confirmed new state. **UPDATE, Sept 10:** the IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike with a second strike on a genuinely new state, active since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) or the US-casualty clause (none confirmed); sponsorship remains undetermined (Trump's single hedged "probably Iran" refresh, is LEFT AS DRAFT for Alex's manual review regardless of the move's size — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether responsibility for the Sept 8 tanker strike is confirmed, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 12:** the Houthis have now gone further than "closing in" — they hold Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline plus Mayyun (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with figs near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping interdiction has actually been executed by the Houthis, so the widening clause does not fire (same actor/theater), and no US casualty is confirmed, so that clause does not fire. The cut is moderate (no window moved >2 points) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 (2026-09-17_draft) · LIGHT DAILY TOUCH · AUTO-STAMPED · THIS PILLAR HELD FLAT

P (2026-09-17_draft, COMMITTED — light daily touch, auto-stamped; HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Prior committed P (2026-09-15_draft, li (uniform) · This pillar's signals: 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -5.10 · 6mo -3.58 · 1yr -1.25 · 3yr +1.76 — unchanged, and still the single largest drag in the -0.76 · 1yr +1.15 · 3yr +2.76 · THE FINAL NUMBER: -0.11 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.43 horizon-weighted (Neutral) — down from +0.01 / +0. Macro re-rate on the September FOMC projections, not by this pillar

Sept 17 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-17_draft), this version — held flat, and the reason is worth stating plainly. Oil fell this week. Brent settled \$105.83 on Wednesday, down 2.7%, and was would be “measured in days” and Riyadh signalled roughly half of capacity back shortly with full service in about six weeks. It would be easy, and wrong, to read a falling oil price as this pillar improving. With concessions, it is still declining to negotiate with Washington directly, and the Salalah ministerial that was supposed to produce a shipping arrangement is still postponed with no date. None of this pillar's holds for a week. Independent analysts reading satellite imagery of the damaged pumping station think the repair could take weeks rather than days, which is the honest counterweight to the Energy Secretary per the delegated daily authority.

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15_draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened. Conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue,” with **no replacement date** — corroborated across Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attending, no request citing Yemen, which is **single-party-sourced and not used to move P**. FM Araqchi separately said the Iran-Oman understanding “would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.” Brent pushed **1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat). This is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Step 6 verification passed clean — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority **would change my mind:** Oman naming a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced.

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-clearing was **announced on Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq will convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** management of the waterway, building on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level officials from Iran and the six GCC states have gathered in one place since the war began. It promotes better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security.” Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, On the sufficiency bar. **Four counterweights, all new and dated, are logged and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT attend, so GCC participation expected out of Monday's meeting — this is a convening, not an outcome; (3) the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transit — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the “US terrorist enemy”; that attribution is Iran's own and is logically damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13). **Market corroboration, reported** the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired — attributed by wire coverage to this diplomacy plus the already-logged IEA demand forecast. **No flip-line clause fired** sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) remain fired and continue to hold — Brent is still above \$100. The upside clause is unambiguous and has NOT been met: it requires a signed, US-accepted Houthi that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (one announced meeting does not move the multi-year strategic read). The against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability (WebSearch/WebFetch, primary sources) was fully available and verification reconciled clean. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority — widened Sept 2 so that move size, call-band movement, and how novel the news feels are no longer grounds to withhold *direction* of the move does not change that test: the same rules that justified six weeks of downward re-rates justify this upward one.

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars (CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro each held flat on independent re-check (see those reports). Iran War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia's oil production launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11)**, a new target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Energy and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamcheh border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory. HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED remark, logged as exactly that, not as fact. **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities; the clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty this cycle). The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger for US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members agreed to a point (1yr/3yr framing only). The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure was independently re-verified as still holding (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (one announced meeting does not move the multi-year strategic read). **Auto-stamp decision:** this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, not a light daily touch — per the runbook, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. **AS DRAFT: status drafted, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that the Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from “closing in on” to actual island-level control, seized the port of Mocha Sept 10, Houthi forces captured Dhubab and Murad (the last government-held coastal towns) by Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayun Island. Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused, with intelligence/targeting support. Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Salldrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth straight session. Neither the widening clause (Yemen is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the 4→2, 6mo 20→18, 12mo 40→38, 36mo 71→70. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch working throughout), and verification passed clean — under the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority **news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by “Alex (auto-stamped).”** CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat on independent re-check.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own “sustained Brent close above \$100” flip-line clause has FIRED. Brent ended the month nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent closed above \$100 in three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and one decisively so; the two prior cycles called this a near-miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the honest reading now is that the intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with a merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to move P. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth straight session. of 10-13/day. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is attributed to Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72. No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by “Alex (auto-stamped).”** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check; Fed & Macro re-rated up modestly after the August CPI report.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing a missile at a US Navy warship, which was intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously in 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026, 2027, 2028, 2029, 2030, 2031, 2032, 2033, 2034, 2035, 2036, 2037, 2038, 2039, 2040, 2041, 2042, 2043, 2044, 2045, 2046, 2047, 2048, 2049, 2050, 2051, 2052, 2053, 2054, 2055, 2056, 2057, 2058, 2059, 2060, 2061, 2062, 2063, 2064, 2065, 2066, 2067, 2068, 2069, 2070, 2071, 2072, 2073, 2074, 2075, 2076, 2077, 2078, 2079, 2080, 2081, 2082, 2083, 2084, 2085, 2086, 2087, 2088, 2089, 2090, 2091, 2092, 2093, 2094, 2095, 2096, 2097, 2098, 2099, 2100, 2101, 2102, 2103, 2104, 2105, 2106, 2107, 2108, 2109, 2110, 2111, 2112, 2113, 2114, 2115, 2116, 2117, 2118, 2119, 2120, 2121, 2122, 2123, 2124, 2125, 2126, 2127, 2128, 2129, 2130, 2131, 2132, 2133, 2134, 2135, 2136, 2137, 2138, 2139, 2140, 2141, 2142, 2143, 2144, 2145, 2146, 2147, 2148, 2149, 2150, 2151, 2152, 2153, 2154, 2155, 2156, 2157, 2158, 2159, 2160, 2161, 2162, 2163, 2164, 2165, 2166, 2167, 2168, 2169, 2170, 2171, 2172, 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actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent held (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor. **25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip. **STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld from the public. It struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman by a US-guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded, no American personnel were harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets in addition to CENTCOM's own report (and an unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels rather than a quiet single-tanker interdiction. Separately, Sept 6 (today) brings further IRGC claims — three more tankers, three "US-linked" vessels, and a US ship not yet US-confirmed, and are NOT used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed US deaths (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island (markets closed Saturday) — still short of \$100. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73.** No window moved more than 2 points. The master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral, checked both against the prior committed baseline and against an isolated same-BTC-price comparison) — so per the runbook's definition, **(auto-stamped)."**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night of escalation. The widening-to-a-new-state clause still does not fire. Brent held roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with forensic evidence of a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments identified) — this upgrades the casualty claim's sourcing from single-narrative to independently corroborated by a primary Western wire service (and investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing new escalation, so it does not independently move P; (2) Sept 5 (today, developing): Iran's primary oil-export terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. V. V. hit on Iran's core oil-export infrastructure, distinct from the Sept 1-2 tanker-hull strikes). Also noted: Iran reportedly warned the US that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale" missile run — a live pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. CORRECTION:** this cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026," but config/scores.json's status field was not updated retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the Sept 5 tanker struck 3 miles off Kharg Island per Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of three US warship warnings occurred. However, AP's own wire story on the incident is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" — treating it as an accusation, not a confirmed fact — and US Central Command has not confirmed it. From CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — that precedent is already on the record. Confirmation (CENTCOM/Pentagon on the record) or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings were issued and a strike occurred. Not used to move P this cycle, consistent with the daily touch's conclusion a few hours earlier. WATCH NEXT CYCLE for CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired (Brent held Day 189), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE strikes were both repeat targets), and Brent held ~\$95-96/bbl Sept 3-4 — up roughly 9% w/w on the broader escalation but still short of \$100. **categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026.**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** was the Sept 5 strike across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for the governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it, and this claim is explicitly flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level. The Sept 5 missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause does not fire. Multi-source confirmation.

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line. No confirmed casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100, but the already-fired "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what's driving the move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not a record threatening still-larger responses. A confirmed new US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further move.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced, not lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and this pillar's own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war's first-ever direct strike on a government oil tanker — pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents didn't cleanly cover; (3) both sides were on-record threatening much larger responses ahead ("significantly larger" from Trump, "many times greater" from Iran). The master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegated daily auto-stamp.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are not used to move P this cycle, or an unresolved verification inconsistency. This cycle had neither: the research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. The stamping threshold did. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.**

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit trail and recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set 2026-09-17_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- NEW, dated, and supply-side rather than war-risk:** U.S. Energy Secretary Chris Wright told CNBC on Tuesday Sept 15 that the Saudi East-West pipeline outage is a "brief and temporary interruption" and that operations will be back within days and full operations in about six weeks.
- Oil duly fell — reported as a MARKET PRICE, not a score input:** Brent -2.7% to settle at **\$105.83** on Sept 16 and near **\$102.85** on Sept 17 (-2.8%); WTI -3.2% to \$102.43. Brent remains at the floor.
- The war read itself is unchanged.** The Strait of Hormuz remains closed; Iran continues to refuse reopening absent U.S. concessions and is negotiating with Oman rather than directly with Washington. No ceasefire or a US-accepted reopening holding a clean week — neither is close.
- Honest counterweight to the restart framing:** independent analysts citing satellite imagery of the damaged pumping station warn repairs could run weeks, not days.
- Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** A cheaper barrel is not a better war. The 1mo and 3mo windows are at the floor regardless. **AUTO-STAMPED.**

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity. **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was reported: Bahrain declined to attend; Omani FM Albusaidi gave no new date and no reason beyond "in the interests of consensus."
- Saudi Arabia's East-West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said how long it will be closed. Diplomatic channels are **unconfirmed by Aramco or the Ministry of Energy — reported, not scored.**
- INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored:** Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent party. Not used to move P, trying to *raise* Hormuz shipments — a mildly de-escalatory datapoint, also single-sourced and not scored.
- MARKET PRICES, reported not scored:** Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14-15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustained escalation" clause, but no actual ceasefire or strait reopening, and the downside direct-US-strikes clause is unfired.
- Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set 2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the ministerial meeting until conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." Corroborated independently by Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's research reported.

- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already confirmed** for is weaker evidence of de-escalation than a meeting announced.
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman character score. Omani FM Badr Albusaidi posted on X that Oman remains "determined to promote dialogue that contributes to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian). He also confirmed the bilateral technical work is real: navigational charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement retracing.
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.
- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated **March** — search surface presented them without dates.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC realignment one point above Sept 12 for the surviving Iran-Oman bilateral framework) · 36mo flat (nothing structural moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED**.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq** Agenda: safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time PRIMARY: the Iranian MFA's own statement ("to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security"); corroborated by 6+ independent Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the Houthis for the struck Jazan, Saudi Arabia, causing injuries and damaging a mosque; Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributed to market price, not the mover.
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and clean week — an announced meeting with no deal expected is not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the meeting **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"** — an ordinary light daily touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficient.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ ★ **NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone** corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both counterweight.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY** weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad by them the ENTIRE Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, "closing in" characterization.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new late.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000 bbl/d** Ministry confirmed several energy facilities and utilities temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The target — the widening clause does not fire, but this is materially more severe than prior Saudi-linked incidents.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy continuing US-Iran tanker exchanges — the closest this war has come to a sustained >\$100 close, still not formally called fired).
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (Today, CDM Press). Iran's Azizi threatens on-record retaliation Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3 (third session not yet a formally sustained close). No window moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new late.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces (GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line actor/theater already priced; no strait closure actually confirmed).
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause index sustained close). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:*

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Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full week refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never drafted (reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, cutting and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel episode")
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — then abandoned
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) framed the report as a "novel episode" — this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel episode" framing was a cycle.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (100+ broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, but doesn't change the point estimate
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the incident as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs 60 in Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran says it's not a strike
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a "novel episode"
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; HOD (delegated daily auto-stamp authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Retrieved & graded September 17, 2026, LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-17_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself.

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- September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem statement, ship names (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) and the IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 5 confirmed, NOT used to move P · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 close (US/\$79,646.11 (Sept 5)).
- September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed Reuters (via Spokesman-Review, Nukta, Tribune, TBS News, unnn.ua) — four independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding strike was likely a Times of Israel liveblog, Euronews, Newswire.lk — Sept 5 Iranian-media-only (Fars) report of a tanker strike near Kharg Island, unconfirmed by CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/ISW — Iran's warning Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
- September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strike (cruise-missile/drone launchers) and the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhestak, Houthi, CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, per this report's own sufficiency rule) · Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating reporting on the confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump's "significantly larger response" threat and an unnamed senior Iranian military source's "many times greater" quote · multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~+5% Tue Sept 1).
- September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine, Maritime, Iran International — corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an intercept; is still weighing further strikes on Iran ("a relatively little war for us") · multiple market-desk reports (e.g. Bloomberg's Sept 1 oil roundup) — Brent ~+2% Tuesday Sept 1 on fresh-clash fears · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).
- August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/NBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on "Iran War: US Strikes Rocket Launchers Near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · CNBC — "U.S. strikes Iranian rocket launchers near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · NBC News — "U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers... first missile hit Strait of Hormuz" · The Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Time News, WLT Report (Aug 30, corroborating) · Korea Times, India TV News, RFE/RL — Iran's IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on King Hussein and Al-Aziz — "Iran targets Jordan after first US attack in a month" (Aug 31) · Reuters/CNBC — renewed exchange weighing on Asian equities and US futures, oil higher · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,447.16 (Aug 31) vs. \$77,666.16 (Aug 29).
- August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes (crypto-intelligence corroboration of the 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.com · mine-clearing project · Iranian state media (Aug 26) — Iran says the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance.
- August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing: 70 incidents · USNI News (Aug 21 & Aug 28), citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24) — sourced reporting (via UPI, France24) — Aug 24 tanker incident off Oman · UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (Aug 26) — IRGC spoke via Reuters · TradingEconomics, various (Aug 25-28) — Brent ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), second straight weekly decline · GlobalSecurity.org Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) — 28th consecutive day of strikes · Michael Emmanuel Swinton confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22-29 death · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).
- August 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above:** UKMTO-sourced reporting (via OANN) — Aug 27 tanker fire, extinguished, crew safe, "second attack this week" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demilitarization spokesman's Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, explicitly checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry; the two countries' own joint statement describes only an "interim framework" · TradingEconomics.
- August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative "Incidents" page (imo.org, fetched directly) — 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike) — flat "18th death"; this softens the morning draft's framing throughout this report · Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday (all Aug 19) — UAE missile-attack and trade-embargo reporting, initially flat baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline · TradingEconomics, Bloomberg (Aug 20-21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl, 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
- August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial framing: 18th seafarer death since the campaign began late Feb 2026, UN News separately reports three seafarers killed in a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft 1) · News, The National, and UAE's own mofa.gov.ae — CONFIRMS the UAE-attack-history correction: a large Iran-attributed missile/drone barrage hit UAE Apr 1-8 (ceasefire Apr 8) and again at Fujairah Petroleum Industries International Company framing carried since Aug 20.
- August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, 18th seafarer death, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News (Aug 17-19) — tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's toll regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran, promised, pushed to "early next week"; narrower Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah-network designation confirmed as the only concrete action found · TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune (Aug 21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl, 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
- August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible deal with Iran · UK Maritime Trade Operations (Aug 18) — commercial vessel struck by unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic sanctions" framing, says US "might return to negotiations at some point... situation is so good" · TradingEconomics / Bloomberg (Aug 19) — Brent ~\$92/bbl · Financial Times, citing unnamed Iranian officials — claim that US "unsubstantiated by any second outlet this cycle; logged as a watch item, explicitly NOT used to move any P · Bitstamp — BTC \$71,882.92 (Aug 20 close) vs. \$64,285.10 (Aug 18 close).
- August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate):** CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in the threat, Strait traffic 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 prior weekend; pre-war baseline re-checked this cycle to ~110/day, not the ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires, Trump threatens to bomb Oman" \$90.97 (Aug 18).
- August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on energy-policy — confirms the interim arrangement is still advancing, not collapsed, despite continued shipping attacks.
- August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal opening uncertain" · The Hill — "Iran's steep demands for US over Strait of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirmed by Reuters closure.
- August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US" — coverage archives, re-checked, no signing found as of Aug 13.
- August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement coverage re-checked — no signing found as of Aug 11.
- August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — Hormuz coverage these.
- August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 8) — condemnation of "repeated attacks" all trace to this single Reuters wire story.
- August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · wire coverage of the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it will reach agreement with Oman for Strait of Hormuz prohibits U.S. and Israeli vessels" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran-Oman Deal Progressing" (Aug 6).
- August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping deal (Aug 7) · CNN live updates — continuing Iran/Oman/US Hormuz coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
- August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 5) — updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz deal week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO — DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint statement (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Aug 5.
- July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by Times of Israel · CNN — "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries" (Jul 30) · Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- July 11-13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack dropped, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned to Riyadh and RTÉ (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmail Baqaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — GFS Galaxy attack and rescue (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaieteur News — Iranian Hezbollah, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinger (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000-63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks.
- July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (refined)

- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited v strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury w 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Teh unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · (*Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial str* chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polym inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) a